“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 11

Śrī Caitanya’s Kīrtana Pastimes at the Temple of Jagannātha

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 Performing a wildly leaping dance with His devotees in the temple of Śrī Jagannātha, Gauracandra, His limbs adorned with many ecstatic moods, by His own splendour plunged the whole world into a flood of prema.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 The next day Sārvabhauma said to the Lord, “If You grant me freedom from fear, I would like to make a request.”

4 The Lord said, “Speak without any fear. If it is proper I shall do it; if it is improper, I shall not.”

5 Sārvabhauma said, “King Pratāparudra is filled with longing; he wants to meet You.”

6 Putting His hands over His ears, the Lord called on the name of Nārāyaṇa: “Sārvabhauma, why do you say something so improper?

7 For Me, a renounced sannyāsī, to see a king is like seeing a woman — it is like swallowing poison.

8 “Alas, alas! For one who owns nothing in this world, who is turned toward the worship of the Lord and longs to cross to the far shore of the ocean of worldly existence, to look upon worldly people and women is worse even than drinking poison.” (Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka, 8.24)

9 Sārvabhauma said, “Your words are true. But the king is a servant of Jagannātha and the best of devotees.”

10 The Lord said, “Even so, a king is like a deadly black snake. Just as even the touch of a woman carved of wood can stir agitation in the mind.

11 ‘One should fear even the outward form of women and of worldly people: as the mind is agitated by a snake, so it is agitated even by its likeness.’ (Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka, 8.25)

12 Never bring such words to your lips again. If you speak of this once more, you will not see Me here any longer.”

13 Frightened, Sārvabhauma went home, and there the Bhaṭṭācārya grew anxious.

14 At that time Pratāparudra came to Puruṣottama, and with his ministers and friends the king went for darśana of Jagannātha.

15 Rāmānanda Rāya came with the Gajapati king, and before anything else he came and met the Lord with great joy.

16 Rāya bowed down, and the Lord embraced him; the two of them wept in ecstatic love.

17 Seeing the Lord’s affectionate dealings with Rāya, all the devotees were filled with wonder.

18 Rāya said, “I told the king Your order, and by Your order the king has released me from my worldly duties.

19 I told him, ‘I can no longer attend to worldly affairs. If you permit, let me remain at the feet of Caitanya.’

20 Hearing Your name, the king was delighted. He rose from his throne and embraced me.

21 Hearing Your name, he was overwhelmed with love; taking my hand, he showed me special affection.

22 He said, ‘Keep drawing the salary you received before, and free from care worship the feet of Caitanya.’

23 Then he said, ‘I am wretched, not fit to see Him. But whoever worships Him has made his life fruitful.

24 He, the son of the king of Vraja, is supremely merciful; in some birth He will surely let me see Him.’

25 Of the anguish of love for You that I saw in him, not even a particle is in me.”

26 The Lord said, “You are the foremost of Kṛṣṇa’s devotees. Whoever loves you is fortunate.

27 Because the king has come to love you so much, for this quality Kṛṣṇa will accept him as His own.

28 “O Pārtha, those who are devoted only to Me are not truly My devotees; but those who are devoted to My devotees I consider the best of My devotees.” (Ādi-purāṇa; also Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 2.6)

29 “Reverence for My service, obeisance with the whole body, worship of My devotees greater than worship of Me, seeing Me in all living beings,

30 the actions of the body done for My sake, speech that tells of My qualities, a mind offered to Me, and the giving up of all other desires.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.19.21–22)

31 “O goddess, of all forms of worship the worship of Viṣṇu is the highest; but higher still is the worship of those who belong to Him.” (Padma-purāṇa, 6.253.176)

32 “For one whose austerity is slight, service is hard to attain to those who walk the path to Vaikuṇṭha — the devotees among whom Janārdana, the God of gods, is constantly glorified.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.7.20)

33 Purī, Bhāratī Gosāñi, Svarūpa, Nityānanda, Jagadānanda, Mukunda and all the other devotees were there.

34 Rāya bowed at the feet of the four Gosāñis and met all the devotees, each as befitted him.

35 The Lord said, “Rāya, have you seen the lotus-eyed Lord?” Rāya said, “I am going now to see Him.”

36 The Lord said, “Rāya, what have you done? Why did you come here first, without seeing the Lord?”

37 Rāya said, “The feet are the chariot and the heart is the charioteer. Wherever the heart drives, there the soul who rides in the chariot must go.

38 What could I do? My mind brought me here; it gave no thought to seeing Jagannātha first.”

39 The Lord said, “Go quickly and see Jagannātha; then go home in the same way and meet your family.”

40 Receiving the Lord’s order, Rāya went to see Jagannātha. Who can understand the ways of Rāya’s loving devotion?

41 Arriving at the holy Kṣetra, the king summoned Sārvabhauma. Bowing to him, he asked,

42 “Did you make my request at the Lord’s feet?” Sārvabhauma said, “I tried very hard.

43 Still, He will not see a king. If I ask Him again, He will leave the Kṣetra.”

44 Hearing this, the king was grieved at heart, and in his despair he began to speak.

45 “He has descended to deliver the sinful and the fallen; He delivered even Jagāi and Mādhāi.

46 He has descended with this vow: He will deliver the whole world, leaving out Pratāparudra alone.

47 “He looks with mercy even upon people of low birth, whom one is not supposed even to see — yet, alas, not upon me. Can it be that the Lord descended having resolved, ‘I shall show mercy to everyone but him’?” (Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka, 8.29)

48 His vow is that He will not let me see Him; my vow is that without Him I shall give up my life.

49 If I do not obtain the treasure of that Mahāprabhu's mercy, what is my kingdom, what is my body? All of it is useless."

50 Hearing this, Sārvabhauma grew thoughtful; seeing the king's deep attachment, he was astonished.

51 The Bhaṭṭācārya said, "Your Majesty, do not despair. You will surely receive the Lord's grace.

52 He is subject to love, and your love is very deep; He will surely show His mercy to you.

53 Still, I shall tell you one means. Do as I say, and by this the Lord will see you.

54 On the day of the Ratha-yātrā the Lord, with all His devotees, will dance before the chariot, overwhelmed with love.

55 In that ecstasy of love He will enter the flower garden. At that time you must lay aside your royal dress and come alone.

56 Reciting the five chapters on Kṛṣṇa's rāsa dance, go up to Him by yourself and clasp Mahāprabhu's feet.

57 He will not be aware of the outer world then; hearing Kṛṣṇa's name, He will embrace you, taking you for a Vaiṣṇava.

58 Today, when Rāmānanda Rāya spoke before the Lord of your love and qualities, the Lord's mind changed."

59 Hearing this, the Gajapati king was happy at heart, and he firmly resolved to follow this plan for meeting the Lord.

60 He asked the Bhaṭṭa when the Snāna-yātrā would be held, and the Bhaṭṭa said, “Three days remain until the festival.”

61 Having encouraged the king, the Bhaṭṭa went home. On the day of the Snāna-yātrā the Lord’s heart was full of joy.

62 Seeing the Snāna-yātrā, the Lord was very happy; but during the Lord’s anavasara He felt great sorrow.

63 Distraught with separation in the mood of the gopīs, the Lord left everyone and went to Ālālanātha.

64 Afterwards the devotees came to the Lord and told Him, “Devotees are coming from Gauḍa.”

65 Sārvabhauma brought the Lord back to Nīlācala, and then went and told the king, “The Lord has come.”

66 At that time Gopīnātha Ācārya came there. Blessing the king, he said, “Listen, Bhaṭṭācārya.

67 Two hundred Vaiṣṇavas are coming from Gauḍa — devotees of Mahāprabhu, every one of them a mahā-bhāgavata.

68 They have all arrived at the Narendra lake. Lodging must be found for all of them, and prasāda provided.”

69 The king said, “I shall give the order to the paḍichā; the paḍichā will provide lodging and whatever else is needed.

70 Bhaṭṭācārya, show me one by one all of Mahāprabhu’s associates who have come from Gauḍa.”

71 The Bhaṭṭa said, “Go up onto the roof of the palace. Gopīnātha knows them all; he will point them out to you.

72 I do not know any of them, though I would like to. Gopīnātha Ācārya will introduce them all.”

73 Saying this, the three of them climbed onto the roof of the palace, and at that moment the Vaiṣṇavas drew near.

74 Svarūpa Dāmodara and Govinda went with garlands and prasāda to where the Vaiṣṇavas were.

75 Mahāprabhu had sent these two ahead. The king said, “Who are these two? Tell me.”

76 The Bhaṭṭācārya said, “This is Svarūpa Dāmodara. He is Mahāprabhu’s second body.

77 The second is Govinda, His servant. Through these two the Lord has sent garlands, to show His respect.”

78 First Svarūpa placed a garland on Advaita; then Govinda brought a second garland and gave it to him.

79 Then Govinda fell flat in obeisance before the Ācārya. Not knowing him, the Ācārya asked Dāmodara who he was.

80 Dāmodara said, “His name is Govinda. He was the servant of Īśvara Purī, and he is a man of great virtue.

81 Purī ordered him to serve the Lord, and so the Lord has kept him near Him.”

82 The king said, “The one to whom these two gave garlands has a wonderful effulgence — he is a great soul. Tell me, who is he?”

83 The Ācārya said, “His name is Advaita Ācārya. Mahāprabhu Himself respects Him, and everyone bows to Him.

84 This is Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita, that is Vakreśvara Paṇḍita; that is Vidyānidhi Ācārya, and this is Gadādhara Paṇḍita.

85 This is Ācāryaratna, that is Purandara Paṇḍita; this is Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, that is Śaṅkara Paṇḍita.

86 This is Murāri Gupta, this is Paṇḍita Nārāyaṇa, and this is Haridāsa Ṭhākura, who purifies the whole world.

87 This is Hari Bhaṭṭa, this is Śrī Nṛsiṁhānanda; this is Vāsudeva Datta, and this is Śivānanda.

88 Here are Govinda, Mādhava Ghoṣa and Vāsu Ghoṣa — three brothers whose kīrtana delights the Lord.

89 This is Rāghava Paṇḍita, and this is Nandana Ācārya; this is Śrīmān Paṇḍita, and here are Śrīkānta and Nārāyaṇa.

90 Look, this is Śuklāmbara; here are Śrīdhara and Vijaya. This is Vallabha Sena, and here are Puruṣottama and Sañjaya.

91 This is Satyarāja Khān of Kulīna-grāma; and see, Rāmānanda and all the others are here.

92 Here are Mukunda dāsa, Narahari and Śrī Raghunandana, and Cirañjīva and Sulocana — residents of Khaṇḍa.

93 How many shall I name? All the people you see here are Caitanya's own associates, and Caitanya is their very life."

94 The king said, "Seeing them, I am filled with wonder. Never have I seen Vaiṣṇavas with such effulgence.

95 They are all as radiant as millions of suns. Never have I seen such sweet kīrtana.

96 Such love, such dancing, such chanting of Hari's name I have never seen or heard anywhere."

97 The Bhaṭṭācārya spoke these sweet words: "This saṅkīrtana of love is Caitanya's creation.

98 Caitanya has descended to preach dharma, and in the age of Kali the dharma is the congregational chanting of Kṛṣṇa's names.

99 One who worships Him with the sacrifice of saṅkīrtana is truly intelligent; all others are people whose minds the age of Kali has struck down.

100 "With sacrifices in which congregational chanting predominates, the wise worship the Lord who ever sings of Kṛṣṇa and whose lustre is not dark. He is always surrounded by His intimate companions (*aṅga*), His devotees (*upāṅga*), His weapons and His associates (*pārṣada*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.32)

101 The king said, "By the evidence of scripture Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa. Why, then, are the scholars all averse to Him?"

102 The Bhaṭṭa said, "Only one who has received a particle of His mercy can accept Him as Kṛṣṇa.

103 One who does not have His mercy — however learned he may be — will not accept Him as the Supreme Lord, even when he sees Him and hears of Him.

104 "O Lord, only one who is favoured with even a trace of the grace of Your two lotus feet can know the truth of Your greatness as Bhagavān; no one else can know it, however long he may search." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.29)

105 The king said, "Without seeing Jagannātha, they are all running to Caitanya's residence!"

106 The Bhaṭṭa said, "This is the natural way of love: their hearts long to meet Mahāprabhu.

107 First they will all meet Him, and then they will take Him with them and go to see Jagannātha in His company."

108 The king said, "Vāṇīnātha, the son of Bhavānanda, is carrying prasāda, and five or seven men are going with him.

109 He has gone to Mahāprabhu's residence. Why is so much mahā-prasāda needed? Tell me."

110 The Bhaṭṭa said, "Knowing that the devotees have arrived, they are taking prasāda there at the Lord's hint."

111 The king said, "Fasting and shaving the head are the rules for a holy place. Why will they eat and drink without observing them?"

112 The Bhaṭṭa said, "What you speak of is the dharma of rules. On this path of spontaneous love there is a subtler, inner meaning of dharma.

113 Shaving and fasting are the Lord's indirect command; to eat prasāda is the Lord's direct command.

114 One should fast where there is no mahā-prasāda. When the Lord has ordered it, to reject prasāda is an offence.

115 Above all, Mahāprabhu Himself serves the prasāda. Why would they give up such a gain and fast?

116 Once the Lord brought me prasāda, and early in the morning, still sitting on my bed, I ate it.

117 One whom He favours and inspires from within takes shelter of Kṛṣṇa and gives up the dharma of the Vedas and of the world.

118 "When the Lord, on whom the heart meditates, bestows His favour on someone, that person gives up his mind's fixed attachment to worldly affairs and to Vedic ritual." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 4.29.46)

119 Then the king came down from the palace roof and summoned Kāśī Miśra and the paḍichā-pātra.

120–121 Pratāparudra ordered those two to arrange comfortable lodging and ample prasāda for all the Lord's associates who had come to Him, and to see that they could have darśana of Jagannātha freely, without any hindrance.

122 "Both of you must carefully carry out the Lord's orders. And even where there is no order, understand His wishes from His hints and act on them."

123 With these words the king dismissed the two of them. Sārvabhauma came to see the meeting with the Vaiṣṇavas.

124 Gopīnātha Ācārya and Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya both watched from a distance as the Lord met the Vaiṣṇavas.

125 Leaving the Lion Gate on their right, all the Vaiṣṇavas made their way along the road to Kāśī Miśra's house.

126 At that moment Mahāprabhu came with His own companions and met the Vaiṣṇavas on the road with great delight.

127 Advaita bowed at the Lord's feet, and the Lord embraced the Ācārya with love.

128 Both were utterly overcome by the bliss of love; then, seeing the occasion, the Lord composed Himself a little.

129 Śrīvāsa and the others bowed at the Lord's feet, and the Lord embraced each of them with love.

130 He greeted all the devotees one by one and took them all inside.

131 Miśra's residence was a small place, yet the countless Vaiṣṇavas were all accommodated there.

132 The Lord seated them all close to Himself, and with His own hand He gave everyone garlands and sandal paste.

133 Then the Bhaṭṭācārya came to where Mahāprabhu was and greeted everyone as befitted each.

134 The Lord spoke sweetly to Advaita: "Today, with Your coming, I am complete."

135–136 Advaita said, “This is the Lord’s nature: although He is complete in Himself and full of all majesty, still He finds joyful delight in the company of His devotees, and with His devotees He eternally enjoys pastimes of every kind.”

137 The Lord was delighted to see Vāsudeva, and, placing His hand on his body, He said to him:

138 “Though Mukunda has been with Me since childhood, I feel greater joy in seeing you.”

139 Vāsu said, “Mukunda obtained Your company; he obtained Your feet — that was his second birth.

140 Though he is younger, Mukunda has now become my elder. He is the recipient of Your mercy, and so he excels in every quality.”

141 The Lord spoke again: “I have brought two books from the South for you.

142 Svarūpa has them; copy them and take them.” Vāsudeva was delighted to receive the books.

143 Every one of the Vaiṣṇavas made a copy for himself, and so, little by little, the two books spread everywhere.

144 With great affection the Lord said to Śrīvāsa and his brothers, “I have been bought by you four brothers.”

145 Śrīvāsa replied, “Why do You say the opposite? With the price of Your mercy You have bought us four brothers.”

146 Seeing Śaṅkara, the Lord said to Dāmodara, “My love for you is mixed with reverence,

147 but for Śaṅkara I have pure, unmixed love. So keep Śaṅkara with you.”

148 Dāmodara said, “Śaṅkara is younger than I, but now, by Your mercy, he has become my elder brother.”

149 The Lord said to Śivānanda, “I have known from long before of your deep attachment to Me.”

150 Hearing this, Śivānanda Sena was overwhelmed with love; he fell flat like a rod before the Lord and recited this verse:

151 “O Infinite One, for so long I was sinking in the ocean of worldly existence, and now I have found You, like the shore. And You too, O Lord, have now found in me the most fitting vessel for Your mercy.” (Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka 8.42; Stotra-ratna 26)

152 At first Murāri Gupta did not come to see the Lord; he lay outside, fallen prostrate.

153 Not seeing Murāri, the Lord searched for him, and many people ran to fetch him.

154 Holding two bunches of grass between his teeth, Murāri came before Mahāprabhu, overcome with humility.

155 Seeing Murāri, the Lord came forward to meet him, but Murāri drew back and began to say,

156 “Do not touch me, O Lord — I am a wretch. This body is not fit for You to touch.”

157 The Lord said, “Murāri, restrain your humility. Seeing your humility, My heart is torn apart.”

158 So saying, the Lord embraced him, seated him beside Himself and wiped his body clean with His own hands.

159–160 Ācāryaratna, Vidyānidhi, Gadādhara Paṇḍita, Gaṅgādāsa, Hari Bhaṭṭa and Ācārya Purandara — the Lord sang the virtues of each of them, embraced them again and again, and so honoured them.

161 Having honoured them all, the Lord was overjoyed. But not seeing Haridāsa, He asked, “Where is Haridāsa?”

162 Haridāsa, keeping far away and not looking upon the Lord, lay prostrate at the edge of the main road.

163 He had come to the place of meeting but did not go to meet the Lord; he remained lying far off at the edge of the main road.

164 All the devotees ran to bring Haridāsa: “The Lord wants to meet you. Come quickly!”

165 Haridāsa said, “I am of low birth, worthless. I have no right to go near the temple.

166 If I can get a secluded place within the garden, I will stay there, lying alone, and pass my days.

167 There the servants of Jagannātha will not come into contact with me. To stay there — that is my desire.”

168 People went and told the Lord what he had said, and hearing it the Lord was very happy at heart.

169 At that time the two, Kāśī Miśra and the *paḍichā*, the temple superintendent, came and bowed at the Lord's feet.

170 Seeing all the Vaiṣṇavas, they were very happy, and they greeted everyone joyfully, as befitted each.

171 At the Lord's feet the two of them made their request: "Give us leave to look after the Vaiṣṇavas.

172 We have arranged lodgings for everyone, and we will provide *mahā-prasāda* for all."

173 The Lord said, "Gopīnātha, go with the Vaiṣṇavas, and wherever they point out the lodgings, take them there and settle them in.

174 Give the *mahā-prasāda* to Vāṇīnātha; he will provide for all the Vaiṣṇavas.

175 Near Me, in this flower garden, there is a single room in a very secluded spot.

176 Give that room to Me — I have need of it. Sitting there in seclusion, I shall absorb Myself in remembrance."

177 Miśra said, "All is Yours — why do You ask? Take whatever You wish, as You please.

178 We two are Your servants, ready to do Your bidding. Be merciful and command whatever You wish."

179 So saying, the two took their leave, taking Gopīnātha and Vāṇīnātha with them.

180 They showed Gopīnātha all the lodgings and gave Vāṇīnātha *prasāda* in abundance.

181 Vāṇīnātha returned with a great quantity of *prasāda* and cakes, and Gopīnātha returned after making the lodgings ready.

182 Mahāprabhu said, “Listen, all you Vaiṣṇavas: go now, each of you, to your own lodgings.

183 Bathe in the sea and take *darśana* of the temple’s pinnacle; then come back here today to eat.”

184 Bowing to the Lord, they all went off to their lodgings, and Gopīnātha Ācārya gave everyone a place to stay.

185 Then Mahāprabhu came to meet Haridāsa. Haridāsa was absorbed in loving *saṅkīrtana* of the Name.

186 Seeing the Lord, he fell prostrate at His feet, and the Lord raised him up and embraced him.

187 Both of them wept, absorbed in love: the servant overcome by the master’s virtues, and the master by the servant’s.

188 Haridāsa said, “O Lord, do not touch me. I am low, untouchable, the most fallen of all.”

189 The Lord said, “I touch you to purify Myself, for I have none of your pure *dharma*.

190 At every moment you bathe in all the holy places; at every moment you perform sacrifice, austerity and charity.

191 You are constantly studying the Vedas. You are far more purifying than any *brāhmaṇa* or *sannyāsī*.

192 “Oh, how wonderful! Even a dog-eater on the tip of whose tongue Your name is present is most worthy of honour for that very reason. Those who utter Your name have already performed austerities and offered sacrifices; they have bathed in all the holy waters, they are truly noble, and they have studied the Vedas.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 3.33.7)

193 So saying, He took him to the flower garden and gave him a dwelling in a very secluded spot.

194 “Stay here and perform *saṅkīrtana* of the Name. I shall come and meet you every day.

195 Look at the *cakra* on the temple and offer your obeisance. Your *prasāda* will be brought to you here.”

196 Nityānanda, Jagadānanda, Dāmodara and Mukunda all met Haridāsa and rejoiced.

197 After bathing in the sea, the Lord returned to His residence, and Advaita and the others went to bathe in the ocean.

198 On their way back they took *darśana* of the pinnacle of Jagannātha’s temple and came to the Lord’s residence to eat.

199 The Lord seated everyone in proper order, and Gaurahari served them with His own sacred hand.

200 The Lord’s hand could not give just a little: He put enough for two or three on every single leaf.

201 Since the Lord had not eaten, no one would eat: all the devotees sat waiting with their hands held back from the food.

202 Svarūpa Gosāñi made his request to the Lord: “Unless You sit down, no one will eat.

203 Gopīnātha Ācārya has invited all the *sannyāsīs* who stay with You.

204 The Ācārya has come, bringing *prasāda* for their meal, and Purī and Bhāratī are waiting for You.

205 Sit down with Nityānanda and take Your meal; I will serve the Vaiṣṇavas.”

206 Then the Lord put *prasāda* into Govinda’s hands and carefully sent it to Haridāsa Ṭhākura.

207 He Himself sat down with all the *sannyāsīs*, and the Ācārya served them with delight.

208 Svarūpa, Dāmodara and Jagadānanda — these three joyfully served the Vaiṣṇavas.

209 They joyfully ate all kinds of cakes and sweet drinks, and every now and then, in delight, they called out “Hari!”

210 When the meal was finished, they rinsed their mouths, and the Lord adorned everyone with garlands and sandal paste.

211 Everyone went to their own lodgings to rest, and in the evening they came and met the Lord again.

212 Just then Rāmānanda arrived at the Lord's residence, and the Lord introduced him to all the Vaiṣṇavas.

213 Taking everyone with Him, the Lord went to the temple of Jagannātha, and there the great Lord began the *kīrtana*.

214 During the evening worship the son of Śacī danced: when the incense and lamps were lit, He began the *saṅkīrtana*.

215 The *paḍichā* came and gave everyone garlands and sandal paste. On all four sides, four groups were singing *kīrtana*.

216 Eight *mṛdaṅgas* and thirty-two pairs of *karatālas* resounded; everyone called out the name of Hari, crying, "Wonderful! Wonderful!"

217 The supremely auspicious sound of the *kīrtana* arose; it filled the fourteen worlds and pierced the shell of the universe.

218 As the *kīrtana* began, love surged up and overflowed, and the people of Nīlācala came running.

219 Seeing the *kīrtana*, everyone was struck with wonder: "Never have we seen such transformations of love!"

220 Then the Lord went round Jagannātha's temple, circumambulating it as He danced.

221 The four groups sang in front of Him and behind, and whenever He fell, Nityānanda Rāya caught Him.

222 Tears, hair standing on end, trembling, sweat and deep roars — seeing these transformations of love, the people were amazed.

223 The tears from His eyes shot out more forcefully than water from a syringe, and the people all around were bathed in them.

224 After Mahāprabhu had performed the “encircling dance” for some time, He stayed behind the temple and continued the *kīrtana*.

225 On all four sides the four groups sang loudly, and in their midst Gaura Rāya danced the vigorous *tāṇḍava* dance.

226 After dancing for a long time, the Lord became still, and then He told four great souls to dance.

227 In one group Nityānanda Rāya danced, and in another Advaita Ācārya danced.

228 In another group Vakreśvara Paṇḍita danced, and Śrīvāsa danced within yet another group.

229 Mahāprabhu stood in the middle watching them, and there a display of His divine majesty became manifest.

230 All those dancing and singing on the four sides said, “The Lord is looking at me!”

231 The Lord wanted to see the dancing of all four, and that desire led Him to display His majesty.

232 Seeing the absorption of His gaze, each knew only that He was looking at him; how He could be looking in all four directions at once, no one knew.

233 It was just as when Kṛṣṇa sat in the middle at the picnic on the riverbank, and each of the friends around Him said, “He is looking at me!”

234 Whoever came near Him while dancing, Mahāprabhu embraced him tightly.

235 Seeing the great dancing, the great love and the great *saṅkīrtana*, the people of Nīlācala were swept away in the rapture of love.

236 When King Gajapati heard of the glory of the *kīrtana*, he climbed onto the roof of his palace and watched with his attendants.

237 Seeing the *kīrtana*, the king was struck with wonder, and his eagerness to meet the Lord grew boundless.

238 When the *kīrtana* was over, the Lord watched the offering of flowers to Jagannātha and then returned to His lodging with all the Vaiṣṇavas.

239 The *paḍichā* brought *prasāda* in abundance, and the Lord shared it out among everyone.

240 Then He sent everyone off to sleep. In this way the son of Śacī performs His pastimes.

241 For as long as they all stayed with Mahāprabhu, they spent every day like this in the joy of *kīrtana*.

242 Thus I have described the Lord's pastimes of *kīrtana*. Whoever hears of them becomes a servant of Caitanya.

243 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.